

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q T 8 5 3 2

♥ 7 3

♦ Q J T

♣ 9 4

♠ K 6

♥ 8 5 2

♦ 9 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 7 3



♠ 7

♥ 9 6 4

♦ K 8 6 3

♣ J T 8 6 2

♠ A J 9 4

♥ A K Q J T

♦ A

♣ A K 5

West	North	East	South
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Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

overruff any of North's trumps.

[showcards W:DQ S:S4,DA W:S2,DQ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♦Q, you signaled with the ♦8 and South won the ♦A.

South then played low to dummy's ♠K, and led dummy's ♠6. Your decision is not whether to play high or low, but whether to ruff or not, which amounts to the same thing.

Do not ruff.

Even though South holds the ♠A, if you ruff now he will just put on a small ♠ and you will be ruffing a loser. Instead discard a ♦.

South will win the ♠A, but will not be able to ruff any ♠ losers in dummy because your trumps can

Suppose you had ruffed the ♠. South would have played his ♠9, leaving himself with ♠ A J. He would then get the lead and pull your two remaining trumps. That would leave one trump in dummy to ruff his ♠J, his only remaining loser.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 2
 ♥ Q 3
 ♦ Q J T 6
 ♣ K Q J 8

♠ J 6 3

♥ A K T 9 8

♦ 8 2

♣ T 9 4



♠ A T 7 4
 ♥ J 6 5 2
 ♦ 9 5 4
 ♣ 5 3

♠ K 8 5

♥ 7 4

♦ A K 7 3

♣ A 7 6 2

West	North	East	South
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♦
All Pass			1NT
1NT by South			
2 ♥ s.			

[showcards W:CK E:S4,C5,C3 S:H4,CA,C6,C2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♣K and continue with the ♣J then ♣Q, taken by South's ♣A. To trick 4 South plays the ♥4. What do you play?

Play the ♥Q.

To see why you should play the ♥Q, just visualize the result if you play low. South will finesse with dummy's ♥8. If East wins his ♥J on this trick there will be 4 good ♥ tricks in dummy. If East withholds his ♥J then Declarer will have 3 ♥ winners.

Now visualize the result of playing the ♥Q. Whether South takes this trick or not he cannot win more than

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 6
 ♥ T 9 8 7
 ♦ J 9 6 3
 ♣ 9 5

♠ K Q 5

♥ A 6 3

♦ A 8 2

♣ A J 4 3

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W		E
	S	

♠ T 8 4 3

♥ J 5 2

♦ T 4

♣ K T 8 6

♠ A J 2

♥ K Q 4

♦ K Q 7 5

♣ Q 7 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

6NT

1NT

All Pass

6NT by South

Play low instead and South will win his ♣Q. But now your ♣K 10 sits behind dummy's ♣J 4 so he can get only one more trick in the suit, the ♣A.

[showcards W:HT S:H4]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥10, won by dummy's ♥A. At trick 2 South calls for dummy's ♣3. Which card do you play?

Play the ♣6.

You would not have been expecting South to play a small ♣ from dummy's holding. The only way it makes sense is if South holds the ♣Q.

If you play your ♣K you will win the trick, but in so doing you will set up 3 ♣ tricks for South, which is all he needs to make the slam.

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J T 9 6
 ♥ -
 ♦ T 8 6 4 3
 ♣ A 8 4 3

♠ K 7 2
 ♥ K J T 9 3
 ♦ 7 2
 ♣ K J T



♠ 8 4 3
 ♥ 7 4
 ♦ Q J 9 5
 ♣ Q 9 7 5

♠ A Q 5
 ♥ A Q 8 6 5 2
 ♦ A K
 ♣ 6 2

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♣	Pass	6♥
All Pass			

6♥ by South

harder for South. Sometimes he will guess correctly and play dummy's ♣K, but other times he will play dummy's ♣J, hoping you have the ♣Q.

[showcards W:SJ E:S3,H7,H4 S:S5,HA,H2,C2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠J, the ♠K is played from dummy and holds the trick. Next come dummy's ♥K, then another trump to South's ♥A.

At trick 4 South plays the ♣2 from his hand and you must decide what to play.

Play the ♣3 (smoothly).

South has 2 small ♣s and faces a choice of dummy plays in the suit. He must decide whether to play you for the ♣A or the ♣Q. If you play your ♣A you make the decision very easy for him.

When you correctly play your small ♣ life becomes

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ T 8 7 6 2

♥ T 5 4

♦ K 6

♣ J 9 6

♠ 5 4

♥ J 6 2

♦ J 8 5 2

♣ A K Q 2



♠ A 9 3

♥ Q 9 8

♦ A 7 3

♣ T 8 5 4

♠ K Q J

♥ A K 7 3

♦ Q T 9 4

♣ 7 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

like he may have 1 ♠ left, very likely the ♠K.

All this means that you should take your ♦A now and return your last ♠ to establish West's suit. Now West's ♦K will be an entry to the ♠s

If you play low, West will have to take the ♦K now, and although he can play a ♠ to establish the suit, he will not have an entry to be able to cash them.

[showcards S:SQ,SJ,C3 W:S6,S2,C6]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♠6. You won the ♠A and returned the ♠9, won by South's ♠Q.

South next played to dummy's ♣A and led the ♦2. What do you play?

Play the ♦A.

Count the points. South's 15-17 plus North's 11 plus your 10 comes to 36-38. So West has room for an Ace or a King, but no more.

West's second ♠ play was the 2, so it looks like he started with 5 ♠s. And the fall of South's ♠s looks